Changes since this edition · Look Book v1.2

This is Look Book v1.1 with this page added in front (v1.2, 6 October 2026). The pages that follow are unchanged and were written on 4 October. Where they differ from what is below, this page and Look Spec v1.3 are current. Sources: Master v4.2 LOCKED, Script Breakdown v3.1, Cast and Locations Spec v1.2, Shot List v1.3, the Director's Playbook (Katz).

COVER · SOURCES

This edition: Based on Master v4.1 LOCKED (3 Oct 2026) and Script Breakdown v2.
Now: Master v4.2 LOCKED (4 Oct 2026) and Script Breakdown v3.1; Look Spec v1.3 carries the per-scene values.

L12 · SCENE 13 PAGE

This edition: Soft overcast daylight 5600-6500K; drops 'catching pale light'; palette #3A3D40 #8C9093 #CBD0D2 #EEF0EF #1B2333; DON'T: no sunlight beams or golden warmth.
Now: L12 = spring sun, one week later: early-spring sun 5000-5600K; palette #34383A #8A8F86 #E6D6AE #FFF6E0 #8DB85E; inside, a warm patch of sun across the table; 3:1 outside, 2:1 inside. Mood frame 12 is the layout reference only.

FORMAT

This edition: Drafts and the animatic: 1920 x 823.
Now: Drafts and the animatic (the Living Storyboard): 1920 x 824.

DEPTH OF FIELD

This edition: Night close-ups shallow (wide-open look); wides deep.
Now: Same rule, with one named exception: 1E/1G (the UNKNOWN NUMBER buzz) is an MCU in deep focus, phone and Claire both sharp.

CLAIRE · HAIR (PAGES 19, 24, 25)

This edition: 'shoulder-length blonde hair worn loose, not tied'; 'Claire: blonde (shade set at casting)'.
Now: Copper-honey blonde (locked at casting, step 4). Present: 'shoulder-length copper-honey blonde hair with a slight natural wave, side part on her left, worn loose, not tied'. Scene 8: 'copper-honey blonde hair neatly tied back in a low ponytail'. Always add: 'honey blonde, not red, not ginger'.

REFERENCES

This edition: Prisoners (2013) for scenes 12, 13: muted gray daylight.
Now: Prisoners (2013) for scene 12 only. Scene 13 is spring sun.

VISUAL THESIS · COLOUR SCRIPT · SCENE 13

This edition: A week later, the light is soft and neutral; colour script '+1 week · NEUTRAL'; 'a week later, soft neutral daylight'.
Now: Scene 13 is full hope: early spring, the sun breaking through after a shower; inside, the sun comes through her window and the drops on the glass catch the sun (script v4.2). Colour script: +1 week · WARM (spring sun).

L1 · SCENE 1 PAGE

This edition: Key: her monitor bank, soft, from the front-left. Distant colleagues out of focus, dim, backs turned. DON'T: no faces on the background dispatchers.
Now: Key: her right monitor (the active call), soft, from the front-right; face half lit, half near-black. Distant colleagues out of focus and dim, faces never readable. Her console has two monitors at the console ends; closed, near-symmetrical framing (Playbook).

LENS AND CAMERA LANGUAGE

This edition: 50 mm is Claire's base lens; height: eye level; composition: centred, symmetrical frames on the platform and the bridge.
Now: The Director's Playbook (Katz) governs: 24-35 mm inside her space, 85-135 mm when the camera watches from outside; eye level by default = the camera at the subject's eye height (Claire 1.55 m standing, 1.12 m seated, Daniel 1.70 m); closed, near-symmetrical framing for the institutions (dispatch, the lobby) as well as the platform and the bridge.

SIGNATURE MOVES

This edition: Phone framing (scene 1 = scene 11); the match frame (7 > 8 > 9).
Now: Phone framing 1F = 11F. Added: the one true CU of scene 1 (1D) is the match-frame setup: 85 mm, three-quarter from her right ~30°, 3.34 m, at her eye line. 7H ends on it, 8A starts on it, scene 11 will repeat it standing.

DANIEL · BEHAVIOUR

This edition: LEFT hand into his pocket at 'They won't believe me'.
Now: LEFT hand into his coat pocket after "They won't believe me. They'll believe the woman who took the call." (script order), out empty after the confession.

STEP 3 · VISUAL DEVELOPMENT

TAP TWICE

LOOK BOOK · V1.1

Based on Master v4.1 LOCKED (3 Oct 2026) and Script Breakdown v2 · 4 October 2026

Written by Mohammed Helal · 2.33:1 · 24 fps · v1.1: decisions of 4 Oct applied



Visual thesis

TAP TWICE is a night that gets quieter as it gets worse. The city is wet, empty and real; nothing in it is supernatural, and nothing in the frame shouts. Every emotion is played one degree quieter, so the picture is too: low contrast in the faces, slow or locked cameras, and rain as the constant texture. Colour carries the story. Claire's present is cool: blue monitors, cyan neon, white fluorescent. Emma's night is warm: the amber platform, the amber dispatch room a year ago, the sodium footbridge. The night walks Claire out of her cool world into Emma's warm one, and the garage holds the film's one pure red: Emma's phone. Dawn drains the colour to gray once the truth is told. A week later, the light is soft and neutral, and the storm is over.

Three rules sit under everything: **one degree quieter** (no shouting light, no showy camera), **nothing supernatural** (every source is a real lamp, sign or screen), and **no readable text in any generation** (all text is added in the edit).

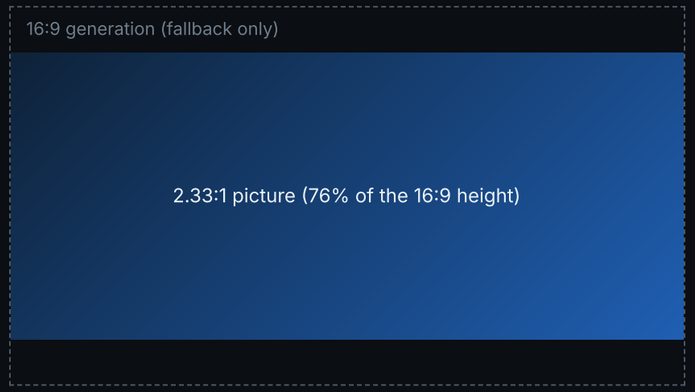
DECIDED FOR THIS LOOK BOOK (4 OCT 2026)

- Aspect ratio 2.33:1 (21:9); timeline 3840 × 1646
- Lens character: spherical, restrained
- Scenes 1 and 8: distant, dim colleagues, out of focus
- Scene 5: deep, desaturated crimson; the red phone owns pure red
- Warm = Emma's night (platform 4, the flashback, the footbridge); cool = Claire's present
- Scene 8: warmer knit top; hair tied back in a low ponytail (present: loose)
- Claire's coat: dark navy wool, mid-thigh
- Daniel: 45, no hat, full head of short dark hair, long gray coat below the knee, always backlit
- Claire: blonde (shade set at casting, step 4)
- Look E: a plain soft gray knit
- Earbud: white
- Grain: generate clean, one even film grain added in the colour grade
- Laundromat: Machine Six's drum glows faintly amber while it turns (Emma's trace)

Format

Aspect ratio	2.33:1 (21:9). Locked 4 Oct 2026. No 2.39 version unless a cinema screening comes up.
Timeline	3840 × 1646 (UHD scope). Drafts and the animatic: 1920 × 823.
Generation	Native 21:9 wherever the model offers it. Nano Banana 2 at 2K gives 3168 × 1344 (2.357:1): scale to fit the height and trim about 1% from the sides.
Fallback	A model without 21:9: generate 16:9 and crop. Keep heads, hands, phones and the horizon inside the centre band (the middle 76% of the height); see the framing guide.
Frame rate	24 fps (23.976) for everything, including graphics and the animatic.
Lens character	Spherical and restrained (locked 4 Oct 2026): round bokeh, no streak flares, gentle halation on neon and practicals only.
Texture	Decided: generate clean (minimal grain) and add one even fine 35mm grain to the whole film in the colour grade (step 12). AI grain differs shot to shot and flickers in video. The mood frames carry prompted grain for mood only.
Exposure	Night: low-key, true blacks with detail in the coat; never crushed into milky lifts. Highlights only on practicals, rain and wet surfaces.
Graphics	Cool-white (#EAF2F8) minimal system, added in the edit (voicemail panels, time panels, captions, call timer). Captions small, lower left, inside the 2.33 frame, never in the bars.

FRAMING GUIDE: 2.33 INSIDE A 16:9 GENERATION



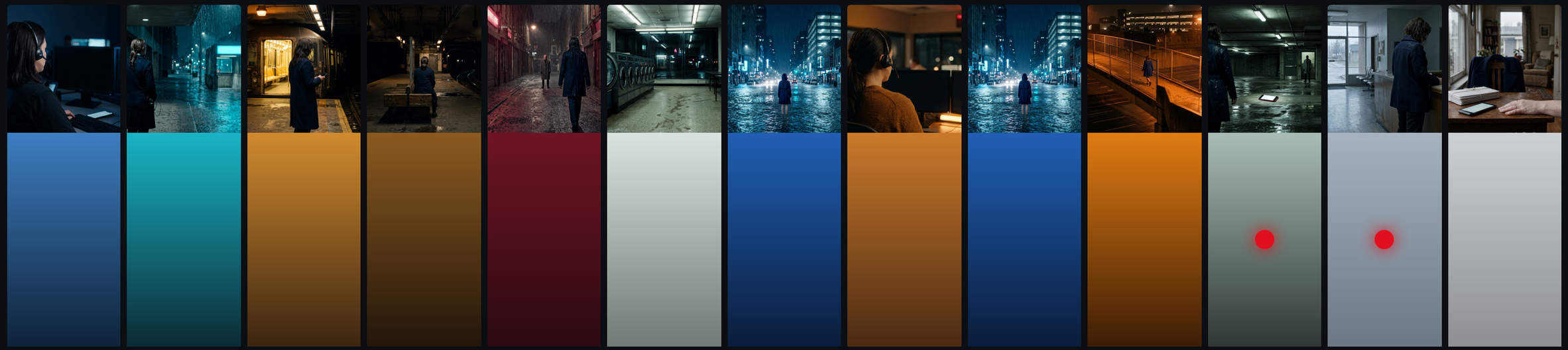
Native 21:9 is the default. Only when a model has no 21:9 option: compose so everything that matters sits inside the inner band, then crop. The bars are cut off, never used.

GRAPHICS INSIDE THE FRAME



Captions small, lower left. Voicemail panels float beside the phone or her head, in cool white (#EAF2F8).

Colour script



1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
Dispatch	Entrance	Platform 4	Platform 4 (half)	Streets	Laundromat	Flooded avenue	Flashback	Flooded avenue	Footbridge	Garage L4	Police lobby	Apartment
2:30	2:37	2:47	2:47	~2:50	2:57	3:07	1 yr ago	3:10	~3:13	3:17	Dawn	+1 week
COOL	COOL	WARM	WARM	DANGER	COOL	COOL	WARM	COOL	WARM	RED	GRAY	NEUTRAL

COOL = CLAIRE'S PRESENT

Blue monitors, cyan neon, white fluorescent, blue neon. Where she controls the call, and where she hides.

WARM = EMMA'S NIGHT

Platform 4 (the train Emma let go), the flashback (the call), the footbridge (her last walk). Plus one trace in the laundromat: Machine Six's drum glows faintly amber ('But she had'). The night pulls Claire into warm light, and warm is never comfort.

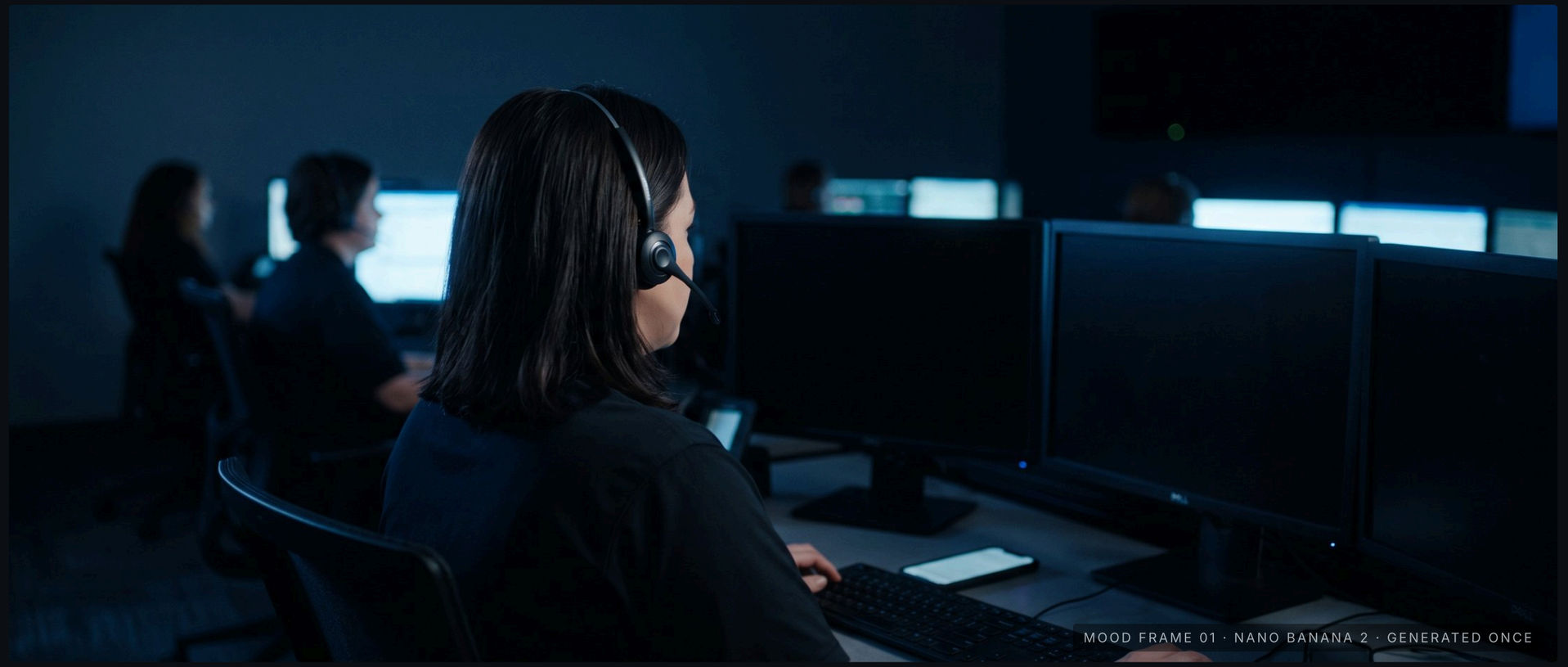
RED = THE PHONE. GRAY = AFTER.

Pure red appears once: Emma's phone in the garage, then on the police counter. Scene 5 is crimson, kept dark. Dawn drains everything to gray; a week later, soft neutral daylight.

L1 · SCENE 1 · 2:30

Dispatch Center - blue monitor light

Control. A professional voice in the dark, lit only by the work.



MOOD FRAME 01 · NANO BANANA 2 · GENERATED ONCE

- Shadow #05080F
- Room #0E2238
- Monitor key #3D7DBF
- Highlight #9CC7F0
- Phone screen #DCE8F5

SAMPLED FROM THE FRAME

COLOUR TEMPERATURE
Monitors 7000-8000K. No overhead light; the room is black between the screens.

CONTRAST
8:1. Face half in blue, half in near-black.

SOURCES
Key: her monitor bank, soft, from the front-left. Fill: none, or under 1/8. Practicals: rows of monitors (dimmed), the phone screen face-up by the keyboard, the analog wall clock (no numerals) catching a little screen light.

ATMOSPHERE
Dry. Still air. Distant colleagues out of focus, dim, backs turned (decided).

CLAIRE
Look A: dry, hair loose, headset on her LEFT ear.

REFERENCE
The Guilty (2018, Gustav Moeller) for the dispatch room and sound-led stillness.

DO
- Fade in from black: sound first, picture second
- Keep the screens blank and soft
- Leave negative space for the phone and the clock

DON'T
- No overhead office fluorescents
- No faces on the background dispatchers
- No warm light anywhere: warmth belongs to scene 8

L2 · SCENE 2 · 2:37

Dispatch Center entrance - cyan neon and rain

The threshold. Dry under the canopy, the storm one step away.



- Shadow #04090C
- Street #0B2A33
- Cyan sign #19B3C4
- Rain highlight #7FE6EE
- Concrete canopy #3E4A50

SAMPLED FROM THE FRAME

COLOUR TEMPERATURE
Canopy downlight neutral 4000K, low. Cyan sign as a 'colour' source across the street.

CONTRAST
6:1. The rain is the brightest thing in frame.

SOURCES
Key: soft neutral downlight from the canopy. Backlight: the cyan subway sign through the rain, making the sheets of rain visible. Practical: the phone screen in her palm (beaded with rain).

ATMOSPHERE
Rain falling in sheets beyond the canopy edge; dry concrete under it.

CLAIRE
Look B: navy coat on, collar down, dry. Headset around her neck.

REFERENCE
Collateral (2004, DP Dion Beebe and Paul Cameron) for the cyan-black digital city night.

DO
- Backlight the rain so the sheets read
- Rack focus from the beaded screen to her face (scripted)

DON'T
- No letters on the subway sign (comp in post if ever needed)
- No streak flares off the sign

L3 · SCENE 3 · 2:37 TO 2:47

Subway Platform 4 - amber transit light

Emma's route. Warm but empty: the first place in the night that belongs to someone else.



MOOD FRAME 03 · NANO BANANA 2 · GENERATED ONCE

- Tunnel #0A0603
- Tile shadow #3A2410
- Amber key #D08A2E
- Highlight #F2C46B
- Train car #F4D35E

SAMPLED FROM THE FRAME

COLOUR TEMPERATURE
Platform 2400-2800K. Train car interior 3200K, yellower and brighter.

CONTRAST
5:1, symmetrical.

SOURCES
Key: overhead platform fixtures in a row. The empty train car becomes a big yellow source when the doors open. Practicals: train headlights (round, no flares), wet puddles between the rails.

ATMOSPHERE
Dripping ceiling seam, puddles. Train wind moves hair and coat.

CLAIRE
Look B, damp: shoulders darkened, hair damp at the ends.

REFERENCE
Zodiac (2007, DP Harris Savides) for dull, real sodium-amber; the warm motif starts here.

DO
- Centred, symmetrical frames (the voicemails are in control)
- Lit windows streaming past her face

DON'T
- No readable platform signage: the 4 and any signs are comps
- No people in the train

L4 · SCENE 4 · 2:47

Subway Platform 4 - amber dimmed to half

Abandoned. The system has given up; she waits anyway.



MOOD FRAME 04 · NANO BANANA 2 · GENERATED ONCE

Tunnel	#050302
Shadow	#22150A
Amber key (half)	#8A5A20
Highlight	#C99042
Bench	#2B2620

SAMPLED FROM THE FRAME

COLOUR TEMPERATURE
Same 2400-2800K, one stop under scene 3. Every other fixture off.

CONTRAST
10:1, pools of light and dark.

SOURCES
Key: the remaining fixtures, patchy. The tunnel mouth is pure black. Practical: the phone in her hand (voicemail on speaker).

ATMOSPHERE
Silence after the train; drips only.

CLAIRE
Look B, damp. Sits on the bench facing the tunnel.

REFERENCE
As scene 3.

DO
- Hold the dim: no lifting in the grade
- Keep her small in the frame on the dimming beat

DON'T
- Don't change the colour, only the level

L5 · SCENE 5 · ~2:48 TO 2:56

Downtown streets - deep crimson neon and rain

Herding. Streets she doesn't know; a still figure where the road ends.



MOOD FRAME 05 · NANO BANANA 2 · GENERATED ONCE

- Shadow #070304
- Wine dark #2A0A10
- Crimson neon #6E1424
- Crimson peak (max) #A33244
- Streetlight backlight #8E9AA6

SAMPLED FROM THE FRAME

COLOUR TEMPERATURE
Crimson neon as colour; streetlights behind Daniel a neutral-cool 5000K to cut his outline.

CONTRAST
12:1. The figure is a shape, never a face.

SOURCES
Key: crimson neon from shopfronts, low and dark (decided: crimson, desaturated; the red phone owns pure red). Backlight: a streetlight behind the figure. Fill: none.

ATMOSPHERE
Rain getting heavier, wet asphalt reflecting crimson. Shuttered, dark buildings.

CLAIRE
Look C begins: getting soaked. Phone into the coat pocket on the subway stairs.

REFERENCE
Se7en (1995, DP Darius Khondji) for relentless rain; Drive (2011, DP Newton Thomas Sigel) for still neon.

DO
- Keep crimson below #A33244 at its brightest
- The figure never moves while seen
- Wide lens on Claire, long lens on the figure

DON'T
- No bright, saturated red anywhere
- No readable street signs: they 'mean nothing to her'

L6 · SCENE 6 · 2:57

All-night laundromat - harsh white fluorescent

Exposed. The only bright room in the night, and there is nowhere to hide in it.



- Window black #0B0F0D
- Washer gray #6F7A73
- Fluorescent key #D9E3DC
- Peak #F5FAF6
- Machine Six drum glow (Emma's trace) #C98A3A

SAMPLED FROM THE FRAME

COLOUR TEMPERATURE
4300K with a green spike (+green). Flat, overhead, shadowless.

CONTRAST
2:1 inside: flat and clinical. Outside the window: black with a little neon.

SOURCES
Key: rows of humming tubes overhead. The front window is a black mirror. Practical: Machine Six. While it turns, its drum interior glows faintly amber: the only warm light in the room, Emma's trace (decided). When it stops, the glow dies and the dark glass becomes a mirror.

ATMOSPHERE
Rain outside. Wet footprints and squeaks on the linoleum.

CLAIRE
Look C: soaked, wet shoes. Earbud into her RIGHT ear. Collar UP as she leaves.

REFERENCE
Zodiac (2007, DP Harris Savides) for fluorescent dread.

DO
- Machine Six's faint amber drum glow while it turns; it goes dark on the buzzer
- Use the reflections: Machine Six's glass, the front window
- Subtle handheld only for the three hurried steps and the hide

DON'T
- No labels or numbers on Machine Six (comp)
- No shadows to hide in: the light gives her nowhere

L7 · SCENE 7, 9 · 3:07 / 3:10

Flooded avenue - blue neon and rain

Drowning in the present. The hiss swallows the rain; the city swallows her.



- Sky #03060D
- Street #0A1C3A
- Blue neon #1F5FB3
- Highlight #5FA8FF
- Flood reflections #3FD0E0

SAMPLED FROM THE FRAME

COLOUR TEMPERATURE
Blue neon as colour; no warm sources at all.

CONTRAST
10:1. Her face lit from one side for the push-in.

SOURCES
Key: blue neon from the side, shimmering on the flood water. Back/top: rain lit by the signs. Far off: the garage decks (pale, cool white).

ATMOSPHERE
Pounding rain, water to her ankles, neon trembling on the surface.

CLAIRE
Look C: soaked, collar up, water streaming down her face, eyes wet in scene 9.

REFERENCE
Collateral (2004) for the city scale; Blade Runner 2049 (2017, DP Roger Deakins) for colour restraint.

DO
- Scene 7 ends and scene 9 begins on the identical close-up (the match frame)
- Scene 9 pull-back ends with the garage decks visible above the rooftops

DON'T
- No readable neon letters
- Don't let the flood look like a lake: it is an avenue with kerbs, cars and signs

L8 · SCENE 8 · ONE YEAR AGO, 3:17 AM

Dispatch Center flashback - emergency amber and monitor glow

The past is warm and dry, and that is what makes it unbearable.



MOOD FRAME 08 · NANO BANANA 2 · GENERATED ONCE

- Shadow #0D0704
- Room #4A2A12
- Amber key #C9792B
- Skin highlight #F0B060
- Queue board red (dimmer than the phone) #B3262B

SAMPLED FROM THE FRAME

COLOUR TEMPERATURE
2700-3200K emergency lighting; monitors neutral-warm.

CONTRAST
4:1: softer and fuller than any present-day night scene.

SOURCES
Key: warm amber emergency lighting overhead and to the side. Fill: monitors. Practical: the red queue board above her (blank, comped), rain on the dark windows behind.

ATMOSPHERE
Dry. Rain on the windows. A busy, tired room: colleagues out of focus.

CLAIRE
Look A-young: hair neatly tied back in a low ponytail, face open, warm rust-ochre knit, headset on her LEFT ear, less worn. Still tired.

REFERENCE
The Guilty (2018) for the room; the amber links this scene to Platform 4 and the footbridge.

DO
- Open on the exact framing of scene 7's last frame
- Warm skin, dry hair: the opposite of soaked and cold

DON'T
- No readable screen text: the timer, the alert and the typing are comps/inserts
- The board red stays darker than the red phone

L9 · SCENE 10 · ~3:12 TO 3:15

Halcyon footbridge - sodium vapor and rain

The turn. For the first time she walks toward him.



MOOD FRAME 09 · NANO BANANA 2 · GENERATED ONCE

- Shadow #080401
- Concrete #3B1C05
- Sodium key #E07B12
- Lamp peak #FFB347
- Highway black #1A1410

SAMPLED FROM THE FRAME

COLOUR TEMPERATURE
Sodium vapor 1800-2000K, near monochrome orange. No other colour on the bridge.

CONTRAST
8:1.

SOURCES
Key: sodium lamps along the bridge. The streetlamp at the far end backlights Daniel. Below: wet highway lanes reflecting orange.

ATMOSPHERE
Rain glittering in the lamps; wet steps; empty lanes below.

CLAIRE
Look C: soaked, collar up. Takes her phone out (RIGHT hand).

REFERENCE
Blade Runner 2049 (2017) for monochrome colour fields; Nightcrawler (2014, DP Robert Elswit) for sodium city nights.

DO
- Monochrome orange: let the navy coat go near black
- Garage decks visible beyond, matching scene 9's skyline

DON'T
- No headlights or traffic on the highway
- No blue fill

L10 · SCENE 11 · 3:17

Halcyon Street garage, level four - strip fluorescent and shadow

The reckoning. Cold, bare, honest light, and one red thing on the floor.



MOOD FRAME 10 · NANO BANANA 2 · GENERATED ONCE

Shadow
#050706

Concrete
#2E3632

Strip key
#A9BDB2

Peak
#E6F2EA

Red phone (hero red)
#E0101E

SAMPLED FROM THE FRAME

COLOUR TEMPERATURE
Strip fluorescents 4000K +green, some failing and flickering. The open side: storm blue-black.

CONTRAST
16:1, pools of light and darkness. The reveal light is the same strip light as hers: no special glow.

SOURCES
Key: overhead strips in rows with dark gaps between them. Practicals: the red phone's glowing screen (blank, comped), puddles holding broken copies of the strips. Daniel in deep shadow by the stairwell door until he steps into a strip of light for the reveal.

ATMOSPHERE
Rain blowing in across the concrete; flicker and buzz.

CLAIRE
Look C: soaked, collar up. Phone RIGHT hand; LEFT hand to her mouth, then picks up the red phone.

REFERENCE
All the President's Men (1976, DP Gordon Willis) for the garage meeting and a man in shadow.

DO
- The red phone is the only saturated colour
- Keep the pillar bare (the 4 is comped)
- Confession: over the red phone, the screen never seen

DON'T
- No cars
- No coloured gels: this is the most honest light in the film

Police station lobby - pale dawn

After. The colour has gone out of the night, and the truth is on the counter.



Shadow #2B3138

Room #6C7782

Dawn key #A7B2BC

Window #D9DEE2

Red phone #E0101E

SAMPLED FROM THE FRAME

COLOUR TEMPERATURE
Overcast dawn 6500-7500K through the glass doors; interior lights off or weak.

CONTRAST
2:1. Soft, low, quiet.

SOURCES
Key: soft gray daylight through the entrance doors. Fill: bounce off the floor. The first daylight in the film.

ATMOSPHERE
Rain has stopped. Wet, still street; gray sky.

CLAIRE
Look D: coat still dark with rain, collar DOWN, hair dried in tangles. Headset leaves her neck.

REFERENCE
Prisoners (2013, DP Roger Deakins) for muted gray daylight.

DO
- Desaturate everything except the red phone
- Let the headset and the phone sit side by side in frame

DON'T
- No readable badges, patches or signs
- No sunrise colour: gray only

Claire's apartment - day, one week later

Waiting, and able to wait now.



- Shadow #3A3D40
- Room #8C9093
- Window light #CBD0D2
- Peak #EEF0EF
- Navy coat on the chair #1B2333

SAMPLED FROM THE FRAME

COLOUR TEMPERATURE
Soft overcast daylight 5600-6500K from the window; skin a touch warmer than the room.

CONTRAST
2:1.

SOURCES
Key: the window beside the table, soft. Fill: bounce. Practical: the phone screen (UNKNOWN NUMBER comped).

ATMOSPHERE
Drops still on the glass, catching pale light. Quiet.

CLAIRE
Look E: at home, plain soft gray knit, dry, clean blonde hair loose. No headset anywhere; the empty hook by the door.

REFERENCE
Prisoners (2013) for quiet domestic daylight.

DO
- Her free hand flat and still on the table
- Hold for the timer: the frame must stay still enough for the graphic

DON'T
- No sunlight beams or golden warmth: the film earns only a little

Lens and camera language

Spherical, restrained. Every shot in the shot list (step 5) names one of five lenses, a height and a movement from this page.

Lens set	Spherical primes, Super 35 equivalents: 24, 35, 50, 85, 135 mm. Name the lens in every shot-list line and prompt.
24 mm	Isolation and establishing wides: the streets (5), the flooded avenue (7, 9), the footbridge (10), the garage master (11). Deep focus.
35 mm	Claire walking, medium-wides, the start of the scene 7 push-in.
50 mm	Claire's base lens for mediums and close-ups; the confession (over the red phone, eye level); Daniel's reveal medium.
85 mm	Tight close-ups, the match frame (7 end / 8 start / 9 start), phone inserts.
135 mm	Daniel from Claire's point of view, always, until the reveal. The compression makes him close and far at once.
Height	Eye level. No low angles on Daniel: he is a grieving man, not a monster. Slightly high only on Claire hiding in the laundromat.
Movement	Locked off, or slow dolly and push. Slow lateral tracks for walks. Subtle handheld only for the laundromat's three hurried steps and the hide. No whip pans, no zooms.
Depth of field	Night close-ups shallow (wide-open look), neon and rain as round bokeh. Wides deep.
Composition	In 2.33, Claire sits off-centre with empty space beside her. Short-sided (space behind her) when she's trapped: hiding in the laundromat, facing the figure in the garage. Centred, symmetrical frames on the platform and the bridge, where the voicemails control her.

Signature moves

PHONE FRAMING (SCENE 1 = SCENE 11)

Top-down on the phone, 85 mm, screen centred and filling about 40% of the frame height. Scene 1: face-up beside the keyboard. Scene 11: the same framing in her RIGHT hand. Screens blank; text comped.

THE MATCH FRAME (7 > 8 > 9)

Slow dolly push from 35 mm to an 85 mm close-up: eyes on the upper-third line, face centred, same head size. Scene 8 opens on this exact frame (dry, warm); scene 9 returns to it on the key-click (wet, cold).

THE PULL-BACK (SCENE 9)

One continuous rising pull-back from that close-up to an extreme wide: her small in the flood, the garage decks lit far off. Slow and steady, no drift.

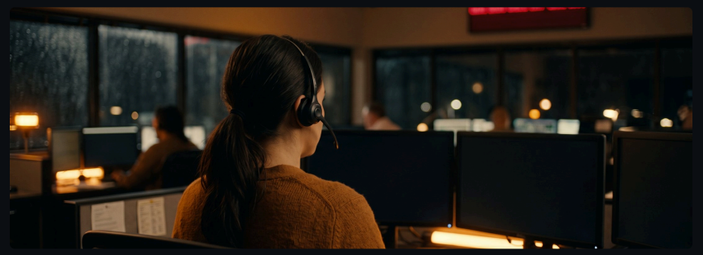
THE REVEAL (SCENE 11)

Daniel steps from shadow into a strip of light. A 50 mm medium, after many 135 mm shots of him. Same light as Claire's.



7 · cold, wet, blue

MATCH TO



8 · warm, dry, amber

CUT TO



9 · back to blue (pull-back)

Claire Mercer · 34 · her looks

Look A
Sc 1

At work, dry. Slate-gray button shirt, sleeves pushed up, dark trousers. Hair blonde, shoulder-length, loose, side part, dry. Black headset over her LEFT ear, then around her neck.

Look A-young
Sc 8

One year ago. Hair the same length, neatly tied back in a low ponytail, face open (decided). Soft rust-ochre knit (decided). Headset on her LEFT ear. Less worn: warmer skin, lighter eyes. Still tired. Dry and warm-lit.

Look B
Sc 2-4

Coat on, dry to damp. Dark navy wool coat, mid-thigh, collar down (decided), over Look A. Headset around her neck. Scene 2 dry; scenes 3-4 damp: shoulders darkened, hair damp at the ends.

Look C
Sc 5-11

Soaked (the main look). Coat soaked almost black-navy, blonde hair wet, darkened and clumped, water on her face, wet shoes. Collar UP from the end of scene 6. Earbud in her RIGHT ear from scene 6 to 11.

Look D
Sc 12

Dawn. Coat still dark with rain, collar DOWN, blonde hair dried lighter, in tangles. Headset around her neck until she lays it on the counter.

Look E
Sc 13

Home, a week later. Dry, clean blonde hair loose. A plain soft gray knit (decided). No headset. The same navy coat thrown over a chair.



A-young · ponytail, rust knit, warm



B · damp, hair loose (the present)

"A year younger" across the match cut: the cut lands on the same face in the same place in frame. What changes instantly is the hair (loose and wet to neatly tied back and dry), the light (cold blue to warm amber), the skin (wet to dry, a little less worn) and the top (soaked navy coat to a rust knit). Her face itself stays the same actress, same make-up base: no de-ageing.

Coat navy #1B2333 (dry) · soaked reads #0F1520

Blonde (decided after the frames were made). The mood frames show dark hair; that is superseded. **Blue scenes (1, 2, 7, 9):** Blonde goes cool ash-silver; it separates her head from the black background, which helps her silhouette in the wides. **Amber and sodium (3, 4, 8, 10):** Blonde turns gold-orange and can blow out. Keep hair highlights below the lamp peak; in scene 8 the warm gold is part of the 'younger' read. **Crimson (5) and garage (11):** Pinkish in scene 5; in the garage, watch the green-white strips: keep skin and hair from going green in the grade. **Wet vs. dry:** Wet blonde darkens to dirty-blonde and clumps (Look C); dried at dawn it reads lighter and frizzy (Look D). That change helps show time passing.

Daniel · the silhouette

Silhouette	45 years old. No hat (decided), full head of short dark hair, long plain gray wool overcoat below the knee (#6E7378), dark trousers and shoes. Taller than Claire. Hands in pockets when still.
Distinct from Claire	Her coat: navy, mid-thigh. His: gray, below the knee. They never read as the same shape, even far off.
Lighting rule	Always backlit by the scene's own practicals (streetlight, sodium lamp, a strip in the garage), never front-lit, until the reveal.
Distance rule	Far and dark in scene 5, a reflection only in scene 6, the far end of the bridge in scene 10, the far end of level four in scene 11. 135 mm from her point of view.
Behaviour	Never moves while seen in scene 5. Turns unhurried on the bridge. Phone in his RIGHT hand; LEFT hand into his pocket at 'They won't believe me', out empty after the confession.
The reveal	Face shown once: a man letting out a breath he has held for a year. Same strip light as hers. Then the stairwell door.



FRAME 13 · COAT SILHOUETTES (CLAIRE WAS DUPLICATED: SEE THE NOTES)

Daniel's coat gray #6E7378 vs. Claire's navy #1B2333

Desk Officer (scene 12): standard dark-navy uniform, no readable badges or patches, coffee mug, log book. Lit by the same gray dawn.

Hero props



MOOD FRAME 14 · SEE THE NOTES: THE HEADSET MUST BE SINGLE-EAR, THE PHONE FULLY RED

Hero red #E0101E: the only pure, saturated red in the film. Nothing else reaches it, including scene 5's crimson and scene 8's queue board.

Dispatch headset	Black single-ear over-the-head headset with a boom mic. Coiled black cable, visibly frayed near the plug. LEFT ear at work; around her neck from scene 1 to 12; laid on the counter in scene 12.
Red phone (Emma's)	Saturated red body (#E0101E), the only pure red in the film. Cracked screen (a spiderweb from one corner). Screen generated blank; the two screen beats are comps (flag 12).
Claire's phone	Plain black, no case pattern, no logo. RIGHT hand. Screen generated blank.
Wireless earbud	One white earbud (decided), RIGHT ear. It reads in the wides, so the continuity can be checked.
Daniel's phone	Plain dark phone. RIGHT hand.
Wall clock (scene 1)	Analog, plain face with no numerals, hands at 2:30. Try it in generation; fallback: comp the hands.
Machine Six	Front-loader with a round glass door. Its drum glows faintly amber while it turns (Emma's trace); dark when it stops, the glass becomes a mirror. No label (comp).

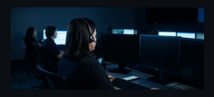
Film references

Named, not reproduced. Watch the scenes for light and restraint, not to copy shots.

Film	Director · cinematographer	What to take	Scenes
The Guilty (2018)	Gustav Moeller; DP Jasper Spanning	Dispatch room, sound-led stillness	1, 8
Collateral (2004)	Michael Mann; DP Dion Beebe, Paul Cameron	Digital city night, cyan and sodium	2, 7, 9
Se7en (1995)	David Fincher; DP Darius Khondji	Relentless rain, wet coats	5-7
Drive (2011)	Nicolas Winding Refn; DP Newton Thomas Sigel	Still neon, quiet menace	5
Zodiac (2007)	David Fincher; DP Harris Savides	Fluorescent and sodium realism	3, 6
Blade Runner 2049 (2017)	Denis Villeneuve; DP Roger Deakins	Monochrome colour fields, restraint	7, 10
Nightcrawler (2014)	Dan Gilroy; DP Robert Elswit	Sodium city nights	10
All the President's Men (1976)	Alan J. Pakula; DP Gordon Willis	The parking garage; a man in shadow	11
Prisoners (2013)	Denis Villeneuve; DP Roger Deakins	Muted gray daylight	12, 13

What the frames taught us

Each frame was generated once and kept as it came out. Where it drifted from the look, the fix goes into every prompt from step 7 on.



01 Right: blue-only light, dim colleagues, phone face-up by the keyboard, headset on her left ear.
Watch: a small brand logo on the monitors. Add 'unbranded monitors'.



03 Right: amber platform, yellow train car, symmetry, damp loose hair.
Watch: the train is a specific older car model; decide the train design at step 4.



05 Right: rain, shuttered street, figure at the far end, crimson on the wet ground.
Wrong: Daniel is front-lit with his face readable and a shaved head ('bareheaded' was read as bald); the neon is too pink-bright and has pseudo-letters. Use 'full head of short dark hair, no hat', 'backlit silhouette, face unreadable', 'crimson kept dark'.



07 Right: the flooded avenue, blue neon on the water, garage decks above the street.
Wrong: Claire is in a hooded raincoat with bare legs. Always name the coat: 'dark navy matte wool coat, mid-thigh, no hood, no belt, dark trousers'.



09 Right: monochrome sodium, the highway below, the garage beyond.
Wrong: Daniel is too close to camera, front-lit, shaved head. He must be at the FAR end under the lamp, backlit.



11 Right: gray dawn, wooden desk, the red phone and headset side by side, tangled hair.
Watch: the headset became a two-ear model; the street outside reads suburban. Specify 'single-ear headset' and 'city street'.



13 Right: the two coats read as clearly different shapes and colours.
Wrong: Claire was duplicated (two women). For lineups, generate one figure per image.



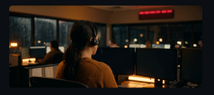
02 Right: dry canopy vs. sheets of cyan-lit rain; the blank cyan sign.
Wrong: her hair is tied back. The present is LOOSE. Add 'hair loose, not tied'.



04 Right: half-dimmed amber, the bench facing the tunnel, small in frame.
Wrong: ponytail again. Same fix as frame 02.



06 Right: flat white fluorescent, black mirror window, wet footprints.
Watch: machine bodies drifted blue-gray, fine; small panel glyphs on the machines (comp or keep soft). The amber drum glow was decided after this frame: it is not in it.



08 Right: the strongest frame. Warm, dry, ponytail, rust knit, headset left ear, rain on the windows.
Watch: the queue board shows pseudo-text (it's a comp anyway); paper notes on the cubicle.



10 Right: strips with dark gaps, the open storm side, puddle reflections, the red phone the only colour.
Wrong: a readable 'STAIRS' sign on the door; the coat came out glossy and belted; the phone screen glows too bright. Add 'no signs on doors', 'matte wool', 'screen glow dim'.



12 Right: drops on the glass, coat on the chair, hand flat and still, soft gray knit sleeve.
Wrong: a hanger is on the hook. The hook must be EMPTY. Add 'bare empty wall hook, nothing on it'.



14 Right: frayed coiled cable, cracked screen, wet concrete.
Wrong: the headset is two-ear; the red phone reads dark red-trimmed, not saturated red; the earbud is black (decided: white). Specify 'single-ear headset', 'phone body fully saturated red'.

Prompt rules (from the frames)

- Claire: BLONDE (the mood frames show her dark-haired; that is superseded). Present: 'shoulder-length blonde hair worn loose, not tied'. Scene 8 only: 'blonde hair neatly tied back in a low ponytail'.
- Daniel: 'a man of 45'.
- Earbud: 'one small white wireless earbud in her right ear'.
- Claire's coat: 'dark navy matte wool coat, mid-thigh, turn-down collar, no hood, no belt' + 'dark trousers, flat black boots'.
- Daniel: 'full head of short dark hair, no hat', 'long plain gray wool overcoat below the knee', 'backlit silhouette, face unreadable', and a distance ('at the far end').
- Headset: 'black single-ear headset with boom mic, coiled cable frayed near the plug'.
- Red phone: 'phone body fully saturated red', 'cracked screen, screen dark or dim and blank'.
- Always: 'no text, no signs, no letters on doors or walls, no logos, unbranded screens'.
- One character per image for reference sheets; never ask for two of the same person.

Decisions log · coverage check

DECIDED 4 OCT 2026 (AFTER V1)

Look E (scene 13)	A plain soft gray knit, dry, blonde hair loose.	Decided
Earbud colour	White.	Decided
Grain	Generate clean; one even film grain added to the whole film in the colour grade (step 12).	Decided
Emma's trace in the laundromat	Machine Six's drum interior glows faintly amber while it turns and goes dark when it stops.	Decided
Daniel's age	45.	Decided
Claire's hair	Blonde. The exact shade is set at casting (step 4).	Decided

EVERY SET AND LIGHTING STATE IN BREAKDOWN V2

Dispatch Center (present)	1	L1 blue monitor
Dispatch Center (flashback)	8	L8 emergency amber
Dispatch entrance	2	L2 cyan neon
Subway Platform 4 + train	3, 4	L3 amber / L4 half
Downtown streets	5	L5 crimson
Laundromat (+ street through the window)	6	L6 white fluorescent
Flooded avenue + skyline with the garage	7, 9	L7 blue neon
Halcyon footbridge	10	L9 sodium
Halcyon garage, level four	11	L10 strip fluorescent
Police station lobby	12	L11 dawn
Claire's apartment	13	L12 day

Claire's looks A, A-young, B, C, D, E · Daniel's silhouette · the Desk Officer · all hero props: covered on their pages.